

Kogge

A Hanseatic cog in squares, triangles and quarter circles

The cog was the ship of the Hanseatic League, the league of merchant towns led by Lübeck that dominated trade on the Baltic and the North Sea from the 13th to the 15th century. The best-preserved cog ever found was built around 1380 and raised from the river Weser at Bremen in 1962. This quilt draws one in the modular manner of the Icelandic artist Siggí Eggertsson: every square of a grid holds one simple shape, and quarter circles turn hard pixels into a round hull, rolling waves and a rising sun.

FINISHED SIZE

120 × 120 cm

GRID

24 × 24 units of 5 cm

PIECES

82 cut pieces, 9 triangle units, 29 quarter-circle units

FABRICS

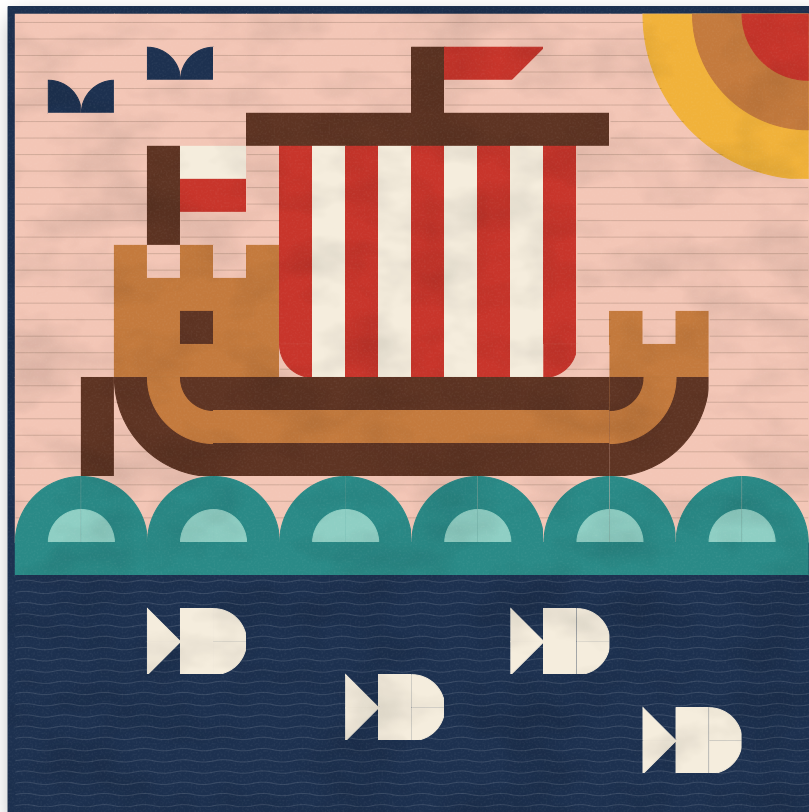
9: sky and navy by the metre, the rest in small cuts

LEVEL

Intermediate

TECHNIQUES

Rotary cutting, half-square triangles, fusible appliqué, straight-seam piecing



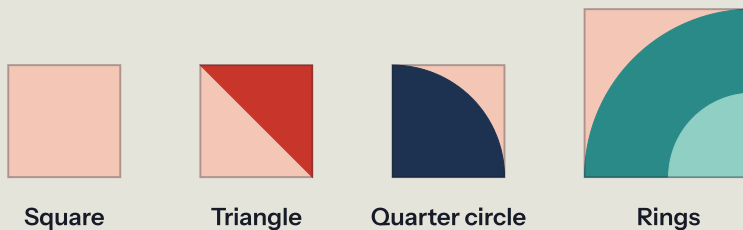
Four shapes, one grid

Each square of the 24×24 grid holds a square of one fabric, a half-square triangle, or part of a quarter circle. Stacking smaller quarter circles on bigger ones gives the rings that bend the copper plank band round the bow and stern, curl the waves and colour the rising sun.

The cog. One mast and one square sail, castles fore and aft, and a rudder hung on the sternpost. Cogs were among the first northern ships to steer that way instead of with an oar over the side.

The flag. White over red is the flag of Lübeck, the leading city of the League. Red and white are still the colours of the old Hanseatic towns.

The herring. Salted Baltic herring, preserved with salt from Lüneburg, was one of the trades that made the Hanse rich, so a shoal swims along with the ship.



The modules. A quarter circle is a background square with a quarter disc appliquéd into one corner; rings are smaller discs stacked on top.

What you need

MATERIAL	AMOUNT	USED FOR
 Sky S	1.1m	Background above the waterline
 Sun gold U	1 fat quarter 50 × 55 cm	Sun
 Hanse red R	1 fat quarter 50 × 55 cm	Sail stripes, pennant, flag, sun
 Sailcloth W	0.4m	Sail stripes, flag, herring
 Copper C	0.5m	Castles, planking, sun
 Oak brown B	0.4m	Hull, mast, yard, rudder
 Teal T	0.5m	Waves
 Aqua A	1 fat quarter 50 × 55 cm	Wave crests
 Baltic navy N	1.2m	Deep sea, gulls, binding
Backing	2.8 m or 1.4 m of extra-wide backing	Cut two lengths of 140 cm, join them side by side and trim to 135 × 135 cm
Batting	135 × 135 cm	Thin cotton keeps a wall quilt flat
Fusible web	1.2 m, 45 cm wide	Paper-backed, for the quarter circles
Hanging sleeve	22 × 115 cm	Leftover backing works
Thread	Grey cotton, 50 wt	Plus thread to match each appliqué colour

Fabric choice. Solids or tone-on-tone prints keep the shapes crisp. Check that the sky, the sail cloth and the aqua read clearly apart, and that the navy is the darkest fabric.

Tools: rotary cutter, cutting mat and a long ruler; a square ruler of 15 cm or more for trimming the triangle units; small sharp scissors for the appliqué; an iron, a pressing cloth and an appliqué pressing sheet or baking paper; a pencil; clear tape for joining template parts; a walking foot for straight-line quilting and an open-toe foot for stitching the arcs.

How this pattern works

Read first

Read the whole pattern before you cut. Cut every fabric as its cutting plan shows and label each stack with its code as you go.

Abbreviations

WOF: width of fabric, from selvage to selvage (105 cm usable assumed). RST: right sides together. HST: half-square triangle. FQ: fat quarter (50 × 55 cm).

Prewashing

Optional. The fabric amounts allow for 5 % shrinkage.

Seam allowance

Sew all seams right sides together. All sizes include 0.75 cm seams. Sew six 6.5 cm scrap squares into a row: it must be 31.5 cm long, give or take 2 mm. If it is shorter your seams are too wide, if longer too narrow: adjust and sew a new row. It matters: with every seam 1 mm too wide, section 1 comes out 2.2cm narrower than the hull below it.

Grid

One grid unit is 5 cm finished. Every piece is a whole number of units, so every seam lines up with the grid.

Piece codes

The letter is the fabric (S sky, U sun gold, R red, W sail cloth, C copper, B brown, T teal, A aqua, N navy), the number the size. H are triangle units, Q quarter-circle units.

Appliqué

Quarter circles are fused to their background squares and stitched before any piecing. Their straight edges disappear into the seams; only the arcs are stitched.

Pressing

Press triangle seams toward the darker fabric and all other seams open. Press appliqué from the back.

Diagrams

All diagrams show the right side. Gaps show the order: the narrower the gap, the earlier the seam.

CUTTING

Cut each fabric

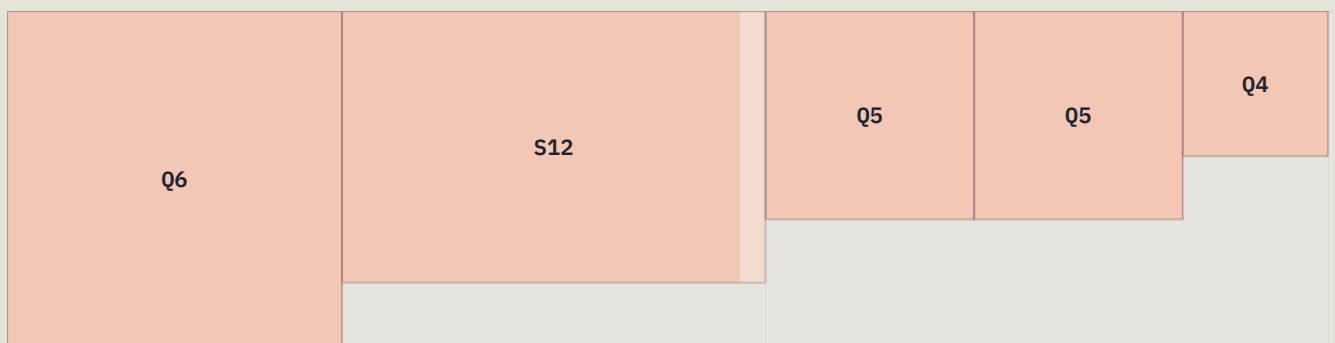
Each diagram is one strip cut across the width of the fabric, with the pieces in cutting order. Grey areas are left over. Squares with a dashed diagonal are for triangle units; squares with an arc are fabric for quarter circles, to be backed with fusible web and cut to shape later. Strips with a pale end are cut long on purpose and trimmed to fit.



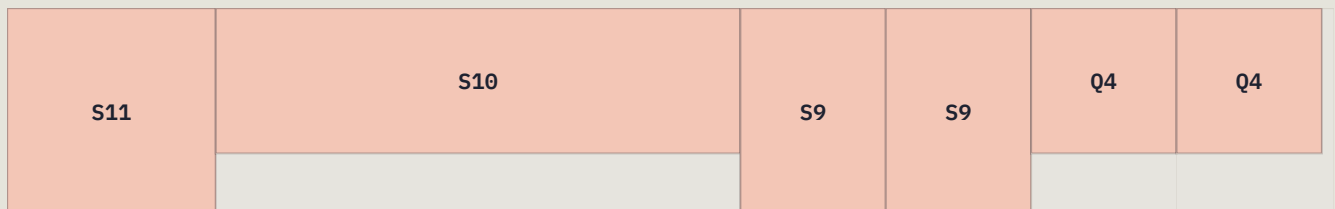
Sky S

1.1m · background above the waterline

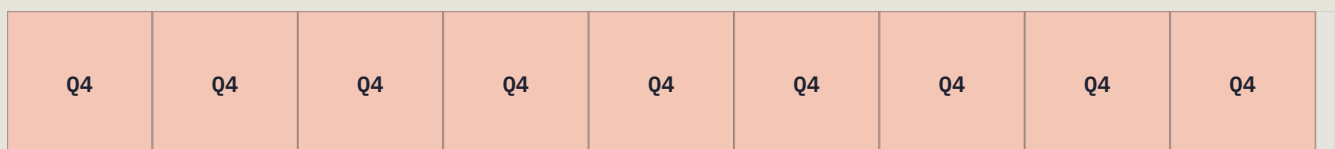
Cut 1 strip 26.5cm, 1 strip 16.5cm, 2 strips 11.5cm, 1 strip 8cm, 3 strips 6.5cm.



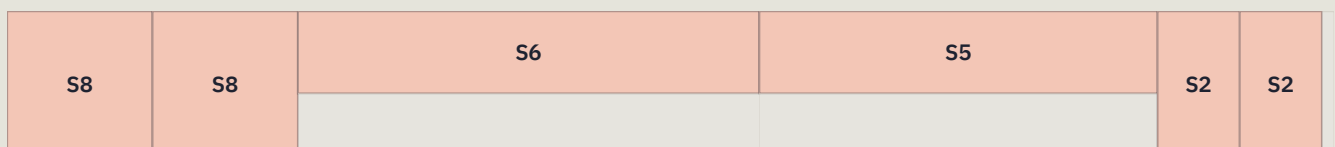
1 26.5cm strip → 1 × Q6 background square 26.5 × 26.5 · S12 at 33.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later), trimmed to 21.5cm wide · 2 × Q5 background squares 16.5 × 16.5 · 1 × Q4 background square 11.5 × 11.5



2 16.5cm strip → S11 at 16.5cm · S10 at 41.5cm, trimmed to 11.5cm wide · 2 × S9 at 11.5cm · 2 × Q4 background squares 11.5 × 11.5



3 11.5cm strip → 9 × Q4 background squares 11.5 × 11.5



4 11.5cm strip → 2 × S8 at 11.5cm · S6 at 36.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide · S5 at 31.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide · 2 × S2 at 6.5cm

	S7	S6
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5 8cm strip → 1 square 8 × 8 for H2 · S7 at 58.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later), trimmed to 6.5cm wide · S6 at 38.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later), trimmed to 6.5cm wide

S4	S3	S3	S3	S3	S2
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6 6.5cm strip → S4 at 26.5cm · 4 × S3 at 16.5cm · S2 at 11.5cm

S3	S3	S3	S3	Q2	Q2	Q2	Q2	Q3	Q3
----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----	----

7 6.5cm strip → 4 × S3 at 16.5cm · 4 × Q2 background squares 6.5 × 6.5 · 2 × Q3 background squares 6.5 × 6.5

S1	S1	S1	S1	S1	S1
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8 6.5cm strip → 6 × S1 at 6.5cm

Piece list for sky

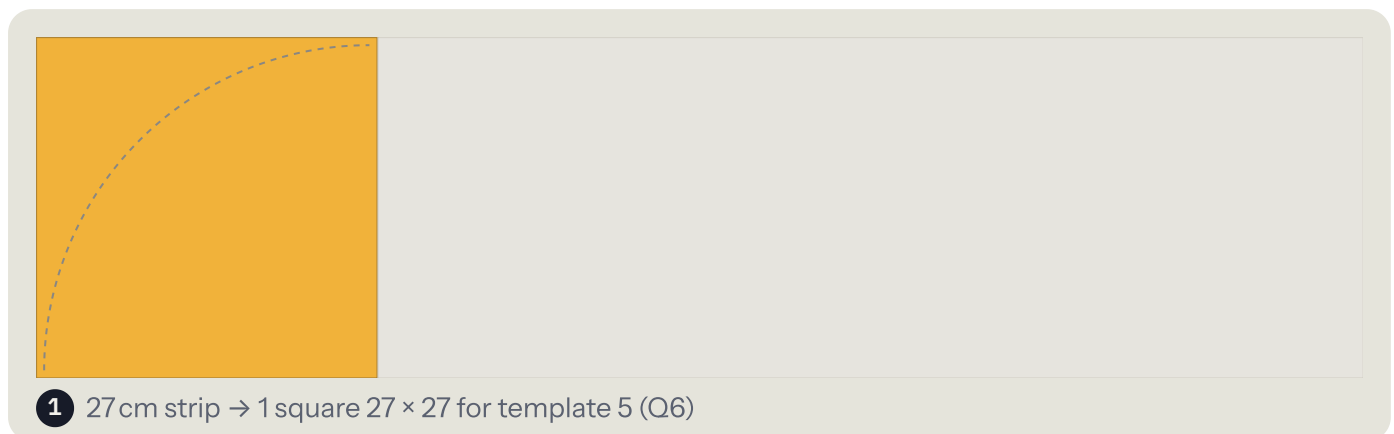
CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
S1	6.5 × 6.5cm	6	section 1×6
S2	6.5 × 11.5cm	3	section 1×3
S3	6.5 × 16.5cm	8	section 1×8
S4	6.5 × 26.5cm	1	section 1
S5	6.5 × 31.5cm	1	section 1
S6	6.5 × 36.5cm	2	section 1×2
S7	6.5 × 56.5cm	1	section 1
S8	11.5 × 11.5cm	2	section 1×2
S9	11.5 × 16.5cm	2	section 1, section 2
S10	11.5 × 41.5cm	1	section 1
S11	16.5 × 16.5cm	1	section 2
S12	21.5 × 31.5cm	1	section 1
H2	8 × 8cm	1	squares for 1 triangle unit H2

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
Q2	6.5 × 6.5 cm	4	background squares, gull wing
Q3	6.5 × 6.5 cm	2	background squares, sail corner
Q4	11.5 × 11.5 cm	12	background squares, wave
Q5	16.5 × 16.5 cm	2	background squares, bow and stern
Q6	26.5 × 26.5 cm	1	background squares, rising sun



Cut 1 strip 27 cm.

Cutting from a fat quarter: cut the same strips along its long side instead of across the width of fabric.



Piece list for sun gold

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
Q6	R 25 cm	1	template 5, rising sun



Hanse red R

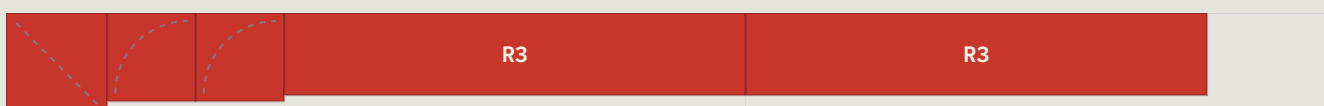
1 fat quarter · sail stripes, pennant, flag, sun

Cut 1 strip 12cm, 1 strip 8cm, 1 strip 6.5cm.

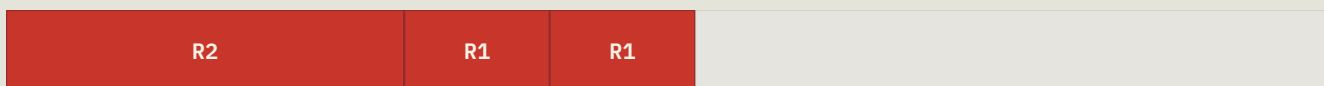
Cutting from a fat quarter: cut the same strips along its long side instead of across the width of fabric.



1 12cm strip → 1 square 12 × 12 for template 2 (Q6) · R3 at 36.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide · R2 at 31.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide



2 8cm strip → 1 square 8 × 8 for H2 · 2 squares 7 × 7 for template 1 (Q3) · 2 × R3 at 36.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide



3 6.5cm strip → R2 at 31.5cm · 2 × R1 at 11.5cm

Piece list for Hanse red

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
R1	6.5 × 11.5cm	2	section 1 × 2
R2	6.5 × 31.5cm	2	section 1 × 2
R3	6.5 × 36.5cm	3	section 1 × 3
H2	8 × 8cm	1	squares for 1 triangle unit H2
Q3	R 5cm	2	template 1, sail corner
Q6	R 10cm	1	template 2, rising sun



Sailcloth W

0.4m · sail stripes, flag, herring

Cut 1 strip 8cm, 2 strips 6.5cm.



1 8cm strip → 4 squares 8×8 for H1 · 8 squares 7×7 for template 1 (Q1)

W3	W3	W2	W2	W1
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2 6.5cm strip → $2 \times W3$ at 36.5cm · $2 \times W2$ at 11.5cm · W1 at 6.5cm

W3	W3	W2	W1	W1	W1
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3 6.5cm strip → $2 \times W3$ at 36.5cm · W2 at 11.5cm · $3 \times W1$ at 6.5cm

Piece list for sailcloth

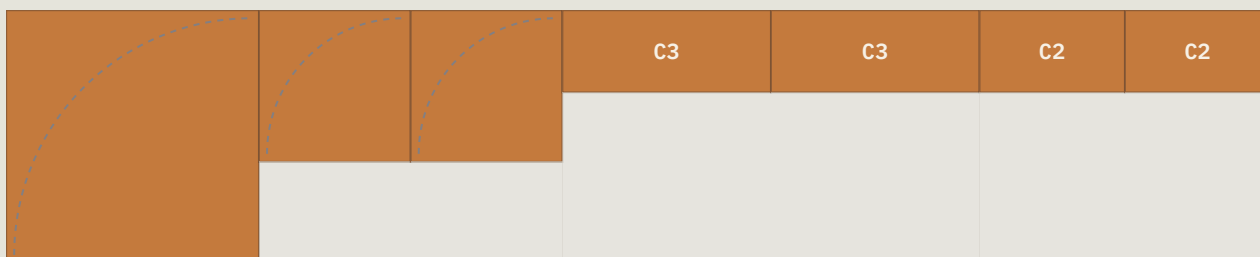
CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
W1	6.5×6.5 cm	4	section 7 × 4
W2	6.5×11.5 cm	3	section 1, section 6 × 2
W3	6.5×36.5 cm	4	section 1 × 4
H1	8×8 cm	4	squares for 8 triangle units H1
Q1	R 5cm	8	template 1, herring head



Copper C

0.5m · castles, planking, sun

Cut 1 strip 20cm, 2 strips 6.5cm.



1 20cm strip → 1 square 20×20 for template 4 (Q6) · 2 squares 12×12 for template 2 (Q5) · $2 \times C3$ at 16.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide · $2 \times C2$ at 11.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide

C5				C4	C4
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2 6.5cm strip → C5 at 61.5cm · 2 × C4 at 21.5cm

C1	C1	C1	C1	
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3 6.5cm strip → 4 × C1 at 6.5cm

Piece list for copper

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
C1	6.5 × 6.5cm	4	section 1 × 4
C2	6.5 × 11.5cm	2	section 1 × 2
C3	6.5 × 16.5cm	2	section 1 × 2
C4	6.5 × 21.5cm	2	section 1 × 2
C5	6.5 × 61.5cm	1	section 2
Q5	R 10cm	2	template 2, bow and stern
Q6	R 17.5cm	1	template 4, rising sun



Oak brown B

0.4m · hull, mast, yard, rudder

Cut 1 strip 17 cm, 2 strips 6.5 cm.

				B2	B1	B1	B1	B1
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1 17 cm strip → 2 squares 17 × 17 for template 3 (Q5) · 2 squares 7 × 7 for template 1 (Q5) · B2 at 11.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide · 4 × B1 at 6.5cm, trimmed to 6.5cm wide

B5				B4			
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2 6.5cm strip → B5 at 61.5cm · B4 at 38.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later)

B5				B3		B3		B1
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3 6.5cm strip → B5 at 61.5cm · 2 × B3 at 16.5cm · B1 at 6.5cm

Piece list for oak brown

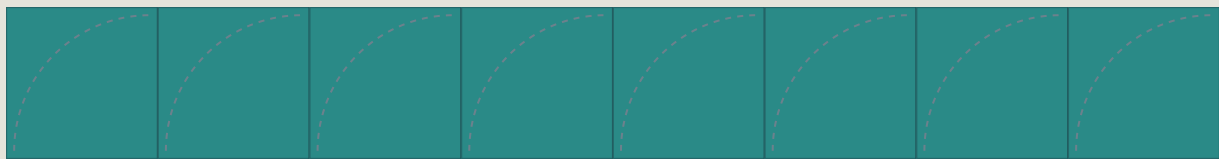
CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
B1	6.5 × 6.5 cm	5	section 1 × 5
B2	6.5 × 11.5 cm	1	section 1
B3	6.5 × 16.5 cm	2	section 1, section 2
B4	6.5 × 36.5 cm	1	section 1
B5	6.5 × 61.5 cm	2	section 2 × 2
Q5	R 15 cm	2	template 3, bow and stern
Q5	R 5 cm	2	template 1, bow and stern



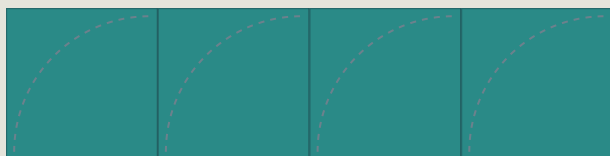
Teal **T**

0.5m · waves

Cut 2 strips 12cm, 2 strips 6.5cm.



1 12cm strip → 8 squares 12 × 12 for template 2 (Q4)



2 12cm strip → 4 squares 12 × 12 for template 2 (Q4)



3 6.5cm strip → T1 at 63.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later)



4 6.5cm strip → T1 at 61.5cm

Piece list for teal

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
T1	6.5 × 61.5 cm	2	section 4 × 2

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
Q4	R 10 cm	12	template 2, wave



Aqua **A**

1 fat quarter · wave crests

Cut 1 strip 7cm.

Cutting from a fat quarter: cut the same strips along its long side instead of across the width of fabric.

1 7 cm strip → 12 squares 7 × 7 for template 1 (Q4)

Piece list for aqua

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
Q4	R 5 cm	12	template 1, wave



Baltic navy **N**

1.2m · deep sea, gulls, binding

Cut 1 strip 21.5cm, 1 strip 11.5cm, 1 strip 8cm, 4 strips 6.5cm, 6 strips 6cm for the binding.

1 21.5cm strip → N7 at 53.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later) · N6 at 41.5cm, trimmed to 11.5cm wide

2 11.5cm strip → N5 at 31.5cm · N4 at 23.5cm (2cm extra, trim to fit later) · N4 at 21.5cm

3 8 cm strip → 4 squares 8 × 8 for H1 · 4 squares 7 × 7 for template 1 (Q2)

N3

Q1

Q1

Q1

Q1

Q1

Q1

4

6.5 cm strip → N3 at 63.5 cm (2 cm extra, trim to fit later) · 6 × Q1 background squares 6.5 × 6.5

N3

N1

Q1

5

6.5 cm strip → N3 at 63.5 cm (2 cm extra, trim to fit later) · N1 at 31.5 cm · 1 × Q1 background square 6.5 × 6.5

N3

6

6.5 cm strip → N3 at 61.5 cm

N2

N2

Q1

7

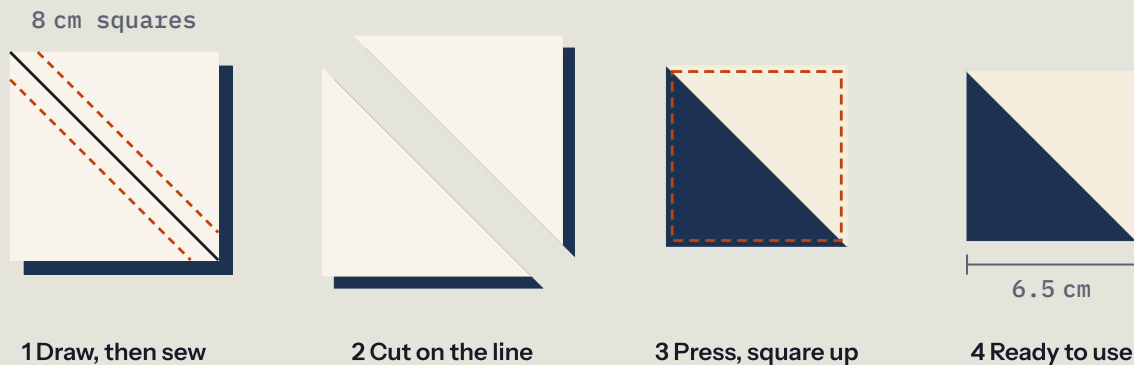
6.5 cm strip → 2 × N2 at 46.5 cm · 1 × Q1 background square 6.5 × 6.5

Piece list for Baltic navy

CODE	SIZE	QTY	USED IN
N1	6.5 × 31.5 cm	1	section 7
N2	6.5 × 46.5 cm	2	section 7 × 2
N3	6.5 × 61.5 cm	3	section 5 × 2, section 7
N4	11.5 × 21.5 cm	2	section 6, section 7
N5	11.5 × 31.5 cm	1	section 6
N6	11.5 × 41.5 cm	1	section 6
N7	21.5 × 51.5 cm	1	section 7
H1	8 × 8 cm	4	squares for 8 triangle units H1
Q1	6.5 × 6.5 cm	8	background squares, herring head
Q2	R 5 cm	4	template 1, gull wing

STEP 1

Make the triangle units



The pale square is the wrong side of the lighter fabric. The drawn line is solid; the stitching lines are dashed.

1. Draw a diagonal on the wrong side of each lighter 8 cm square and place it right sides together on its darker partner.
2. Sew 0.75 cm from the line on both sides, cut on the line and press toward the darker fabric.
3. Trim each unit to 6.5×6.5 cm with the seam running exactly corner to corner: lay the 45° line of the square ruler on the seam, trim two sides, turn the unit and trim the other two.

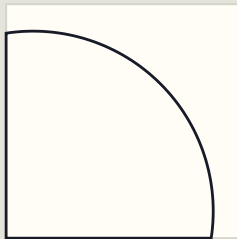
- **H1**, sailcloth with Baltic navy: make 8 from 4 pairs of squares.
- **H2**, sky with Hanse red: make 1 from 1 pair of squares (one spare).

STEP 2

Make the quarter-circle units

29 units in 6 kinds. Every unit is a background square with one or more quarter discs fused into a corner. The discs are traced from 5 templates at the end of the pattern; this list says how many of each to trace, and for which fabric.

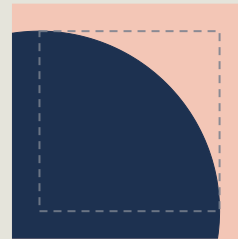
TEMPLATE	RADIUS	TRACE	FABRIC (UNIT)
Template 1	R 5 cm	28	8 sailcloth (Q1), 4 Baltic navy (Q2), 2 Hanse red (Q3), 12 aqua (Q4), 2 oak brown (Q5)
Template 2	R 10 cm	15	12 teal (Q4), 2 copper (Q5), 1 Hanse red (Q6)
Template 3	R 15 cm	2	2 oak brown (Q5)
Template 4	R 17.5 cm	1	1 copper (Q6)
Template 5	R 25 cm	1	1 sun gold (Q6)



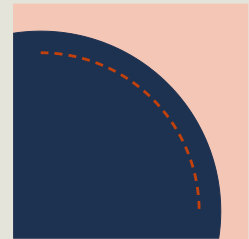
1 Trace on fusible web



2 Fuse, cut out



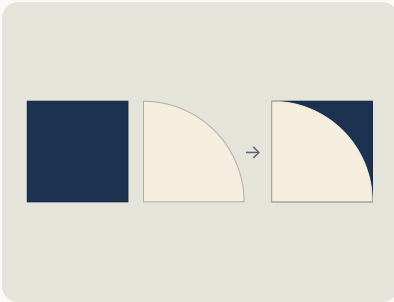
3 Fuse into the corner



4 Stitch along the arc

- Trace.** Lay the fusible web paper side up over a template and trace it as many times as the list says, about 1 cm apart. Mark the corner dot and write the unit code beside each tracing. Quarter circles are symmetrical, so they never need reversing.
- Rough-cut.** Cut each tracing out about 5 mm outside the line. On templates 3 to 5, also cut away the middle, leaving a ring of web about 1.5 cm wide inside the line, so the sun, bow and stern stay soft.
- Fuse.** Iron each tracing, paper side up, onto the wrong side of its fabric square, with its straight edges along two edges of the square. Follow the instructions of your web.
- Cut.** Cut along the curved line with small sharp scissors. With the paper still on, the fabric cuts like card.
- Place.** Peel off the paper. Lay the disc right side up in the corner of its background square, as the unit picture shows: corner dot on the corner, both straight edges on the raw edges. Fuse with a pressing cloth.
- Rings.** Fuse the next smaller disc into the same corner on top of it, then the next.

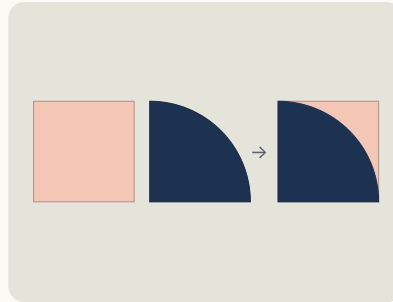
7. **Stitch.** Stitch along every arc about 2 mm inside its edge in matching thread, with an open-toe foot: a straight stitch, a narrow zigzag (1.5 mm wide and long) or a blanket stitch. Zigzag and blanket stitch keep raw edges tidiest in the wash. Leave the straight edges: the seams hold them.
8. **Check.** Press from the back. Trim anything that overhangs the square; the unit still measures its cut size.



Q1 • Herring head

MAKE 8 • 1 × 1 GRID UNIT

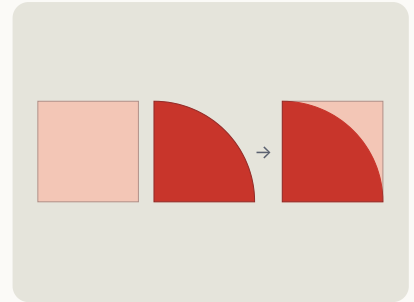
Background: Baltic navy square 6.5 × 6.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 1 in sailcloth. The finished unit still measures 6.5 × 6.5 cm.



Q2 • Gull wing

MAKE 4 • 1 × 1 GRID UNIT

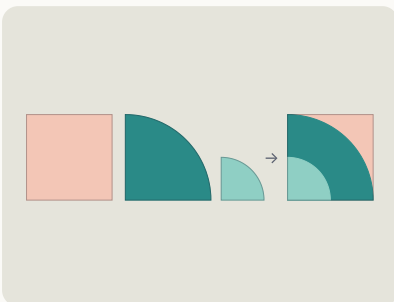
Background: sky square 6.5 × 6.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 1 in Baltic navy. The finished unit still measures 6.5 × 6.5 cm.



Q3 • Sail corner

MAKE 2 • 1 × 1 GRID UNIT

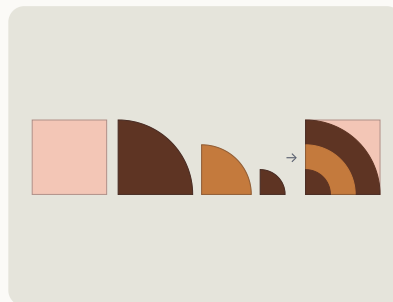
Background: sky square 6.5 × 6.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 1 in Hanse red. The finished unit still measures 6.5 × 6.5 cm.



Q4 • Wave

MAKE 12 • 2 × 2 GRID UNITS

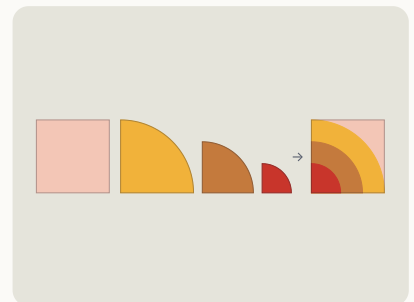
Background: sky square 11.5 × 11.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 2 in teal, template 1 in aqua. The finished unit still measures 11.5 × 11.5 cm.



Q5 • Bow and stern

MAKE 2 • 3 × 3 GRID UNITS

Background: sky square 16.5 × 16.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 3 in oak brown, template 2 in copper, template 1 in oak brown. The finished unit still measures 16.5 × 16.5 cm.



Q6 • Rising sun

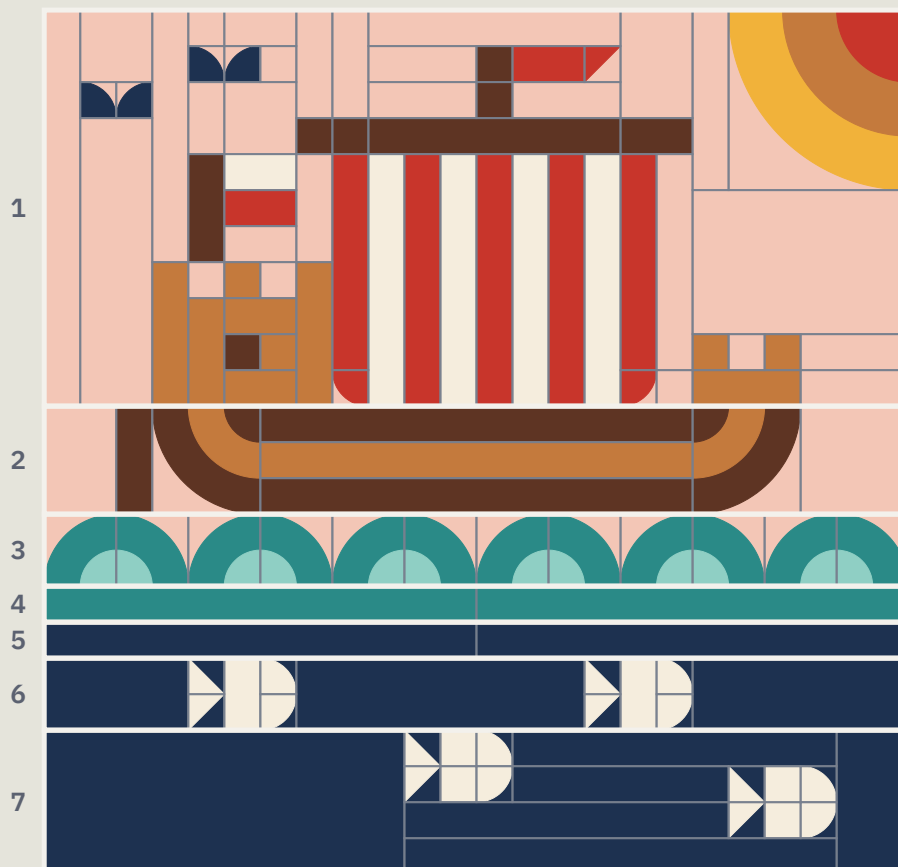
MAKE 1 • 5 × 5 GRID UNITS

Background: sky square 26.5 × 26.5 cm. Quarter circles, largest first: template 5 in sun gold, template 4 in copper, template 2 in Hanse red. The finished unit still measures 26.5 × 26.5 cm.

STEP 3

Piece the 7 sections

The top is pieced as 7 horizontal sections. Sew each one, press the seams open and check its size before going on: if it is more than 5 mm off, take in or let out a few of its seams (each seam changes the width by twice as much as you move it). Turn each triangle and quarter-circle unit exactly as its icon shows.



The sections. Thin lines are the seams inside each section.

In each diagram the pieces are spread apart along the seams you sew. Sections with columns are sewn column by column from the top down, then the columns are joined from left to right.

Icons show each unit as it sits in the quilt. For example  Q4 is a wave unit with its disc in the bottom right corner.

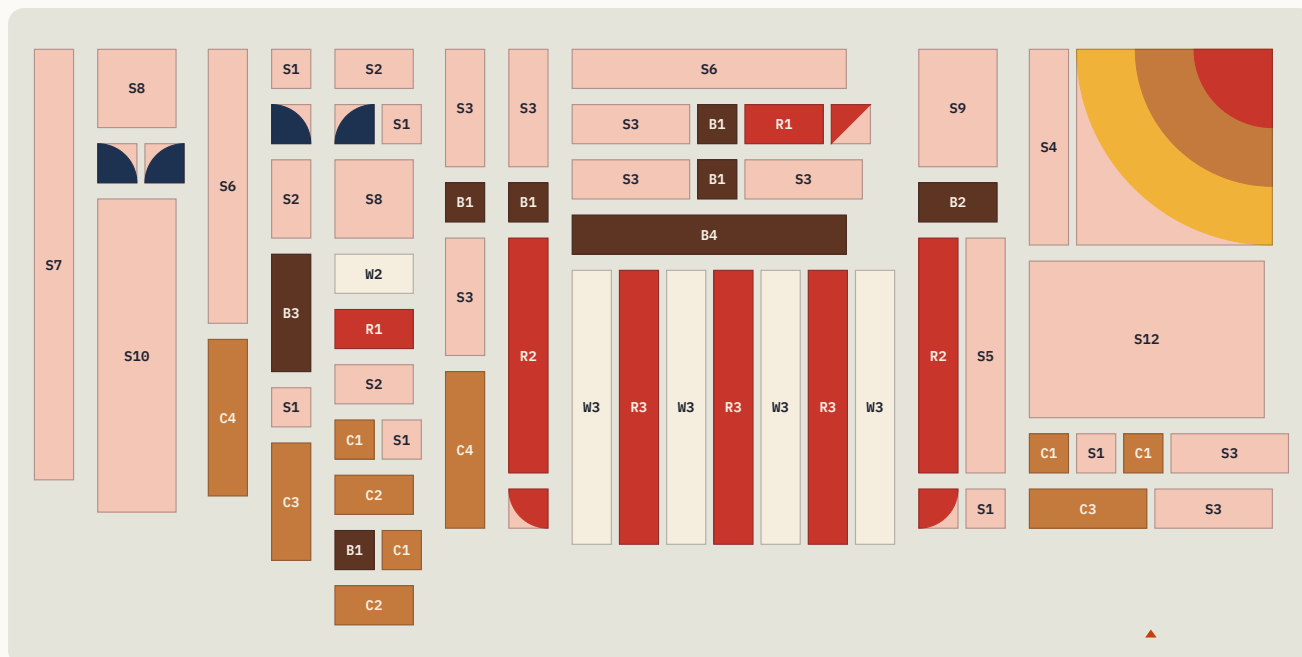
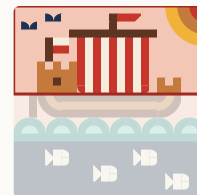
Long strips. Pieces with “trim to fit” in the cutting plan are a little long. Measure the part they join and trim them to match before sewing.

Section 1

1

Sky, rising sun, gulls, pennant, sail and both castles. Pieced in columns.

Measures 121.5 × 56.5 cm



Unit **2a**, left to right:  **Q2**  **Q2** measures 11.5 × 6.5 cm

Column **2**, top to bottom:  **S8**  **2a**  **S10** measures 11.5 × 56.5 cm

Column **3**, top to bottom:  **S6**  **C4** measures 6.5 × 56.5 cm

Column **4**, top to bottom:  **S1**  **Q2**  **S2**  **B3**  **S1**  **C3** measures 6.5 × 56.5 cm

Unit **5a**, left to right:  **Q2**  **S1** measures 11.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **5b**, left to right:  **C1**  **S1** measures 11.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **5c**, left to right:  **B1**  **C1** measures 11.5 × 6.5 cm

Column **5**, top to bottom:  **S2**  **5a**  **S8**  **W2**  **R1**  **S2**  **5b**  **C2**  **5c**  **C2**
measures 11.5 × 56.5 cm

Column **6**, top to bottom:  **S3**  **B1**  **S3**  **C4** measures 6.5 × 56.5 cm

Column **7**, top to bottom:  **S3**  **B1**  **R2**  **Q3** measures 6.5 × 56.5 cm

Unit **8a**, left to right:  **S3**  **B1**  **R1**  **H2** measures 36.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **8b**, left to right:  **S3**  **B1**  **S3** measures 36.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **8c**, left to right:  **W3**  **R3**  **W3**  **R3**  **W3**  **R3**  **W3** measures 36.5 × 36.5 cm

Column **8**, top to bottom: **S6** **8a** **8b** **B4** **8c** measures 36.5 × 56.5 cm

Unit **9a**, left to right: **R2** **S5** measures 11.5 × 31.5 cm

Unit **9b**, left to right:  **Q3** **S1** measures 11.5 × 6.5 cm

Column **9**, top to bottom: **S9** **B2** **9a** **9b** measures 11.5 × 56.5 cm

Unit **10a**, left to right: **S4**  **Q6** measures 31.5 × 26.5 cm

Unit **10b**, left to right: **C1** **S1** **C1** **S3** measures 31.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **10c**, left to right: **C3** **S3** measures 31.5 × 6.5 cm

Column **10**, top to bottom: **10a** **S12** **10b** **10c** measures 31.5 × 56.5 cm

Join the columns left to right: **S7** **2** **3** **4** **5** **6** **7** **8** **9** **10** and press the seams open

S7, S6, B4 and S12 are cut 2 cm longer than needed. Make the rest of the section first, then trim S7 to the height of column 2; S6 to the width of unit 8a; B4 to the width of unit 8c; S12 to the width of unit 10b before you join them.

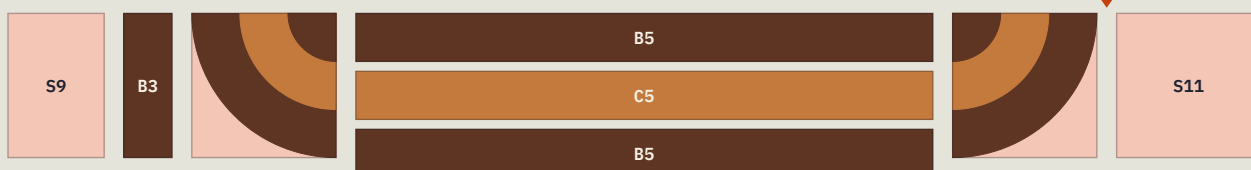
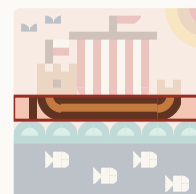
Pin points: 1 with section 2 ▲

Section 2

2

The hull: the two curved ends, the rudder and three long plank strips.

Measures 121.5 × 16.5 cm



Column **4**, top to bottom: **B5** **C5** **B5** measures 61.5 × 16.5 cm

Join the columns left to right: **S9** **B3**  **Q5** **4**  **Q5** **S11** and press the seams open

Pin points: 1 with section 1 ▼

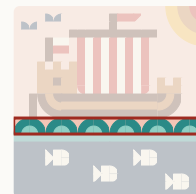
Arc ends to match: 4. Where a ring of Q5 meets a seam or another ring, pin it like a seam crossing.

3

Section 3

Twelve wave units in a row, turned alternately.

Measures 121.5 × 11.5 cm



Join left to right:



and press the seams open

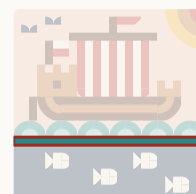
Arc ends to match: 6. Where a ring of Q4 meets a seam or another ring, pin it like a seam crossing.

4

Section 4

The teal band under the waves.

Measures 121.5 × 6.5 cm



Join left to right: **T1** **T1** and press the seams open

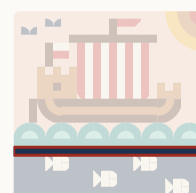
T1 is cut 2cm longer than needed: trim the joined strip to the width of the section above.

5

Section 5

A navy band.

Measures 121.5 × 6.5 cm



Join left to right: **N3** **N3** and press the seams open

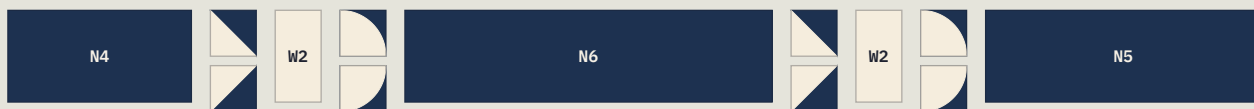
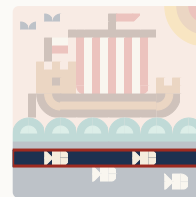
N3 is cut 2cm longer than needed: trim the joined strip to the width of the section above.

6

Section 6

Two herring swimming with the ship.

Measures 121.5 × 11.5 cm



Column **2**, top to bottom:   measures 6.5 × 11.5 cm

Column **4**, top to bottom:   measures 6.5 × 11.5 cm

Column **6**, top to bottom:   measures 6.5 × 11.5 cm

Column **8**, top to bottom:   measures 6.5 × 11.5 cm

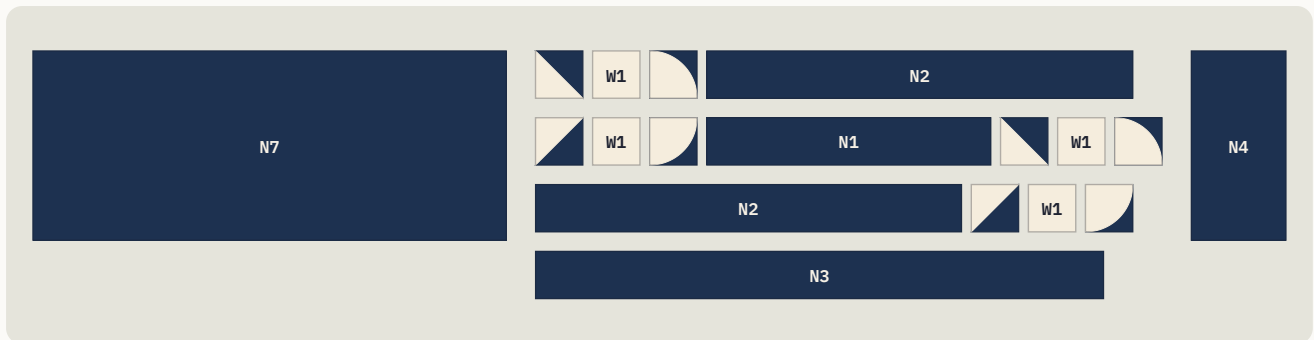
Join the columns left to right: **N4** **2** **W2** **4** **N6** **6** **W2** **8** **N5** and press the seams open

Section 7

7

Two more herring and the bottom of the sea.

Measures 121.5 × 21.5 cm



Unit **2a**, left to right: measures 61.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **2b**, left to right: measures 61.5 × 6.5 cm

Unit **2c**, left to right: measures 61.5 × 6.5 cm

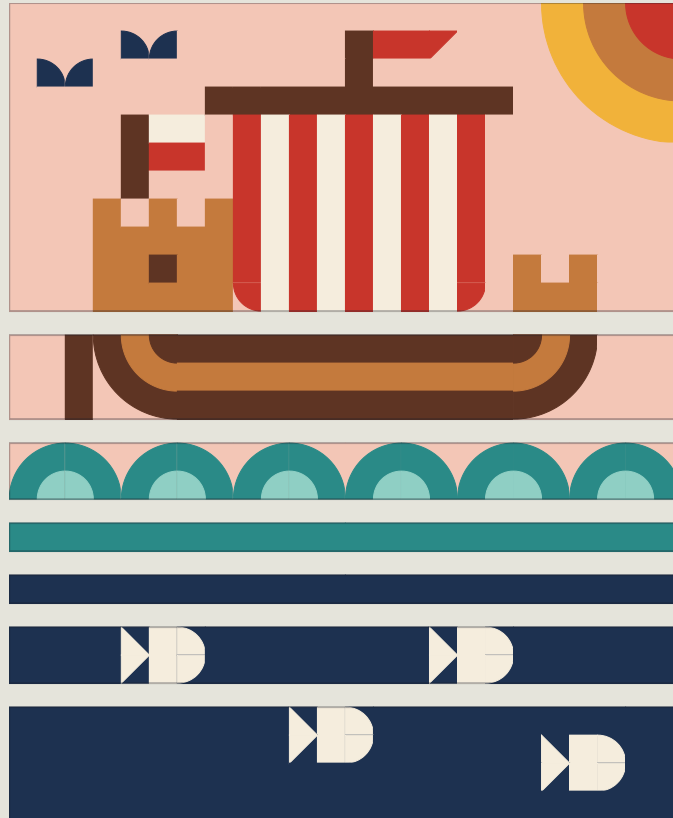
Column **2**, top to bottom: measures 61.5 × 21.5 cm

Join the columns left to right: and press the seams open

N7, N3 and N4 are cut 2 cm longer than needed. Make the rest of the section first, then trim N7 to the height of column 2; N3 to the width of unit 2c; N4 to the height of column 2 before you join them.

STEP 4

Join the sections



Join the sections from top to bottom.

1. Join sections 4 and 5 first: sew each pair of strips end to end and trim the band to the width of section 3.
2. Join sections 1 to 7 from top to bottom. Pin at the ends and at every seam that meets a seam across the join, then ease in any difference between pins.
3. The quilt top measures 121.5 × 121.5 cm. Stay-stitch around the edge about 0.3 cm from the raw edge.

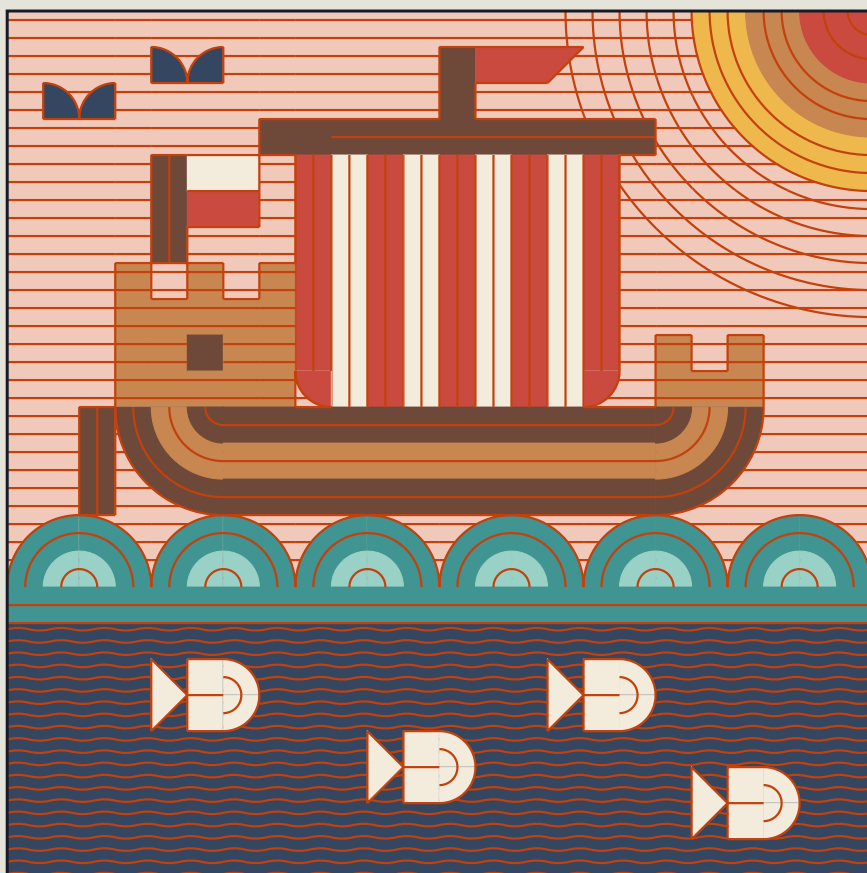
Quilt, bind and hang

Quilting

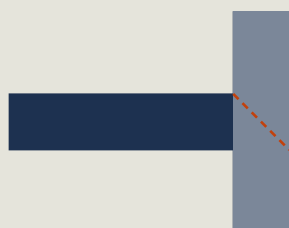
1. Layer backing (right side down), batting and top, and baste.
2. **Outlines first:** stitch in the ditch round the ship, the sun, the gulls, the tops of the waves and each herring. This holds the layers before the long lines.
3. **Sky:** straight horizontal lines 2.5 cm apart, carried across the castles and broken by echo arcs that ripple out from the sun.
4. **Sail:** vertical lines 2.5 cm apart: in the ditch of every stripe and down its middle.
5. **Hull:** one line along the middle of each plank, curving round the bow and stern with the rings. One line down the mast, the yard, the flagpole and the rudder.
6. **Sun and waves:** one line in the middle of every ring (two in the wide rings of the sun), and one along the teal band. Stitch the seam between the white and red halves of the flag in the ditch.
7. **Sea:** gently wavy lines 1.7 cm apart in the navy, stopping at the herring. Give each herring a spine from tail to head and a gill line.
8. No two lines are more than 8 cm apart, close enough for any common batting.

Binding and sleeve

1. Trim batting and backing even with the top.
2. Join the 6 Baltic navy binding strips (6 cm × WOF) end to end with diagonal seams into one strip about 630 cm long; you need 505 cm. Press it in half lengthwise, wrong sides together.
3. Hem the short ends of the sleeve, fold it in half lengthwise and baste it to the top edge of the back, so the binding seam catches its raw edges.
4. Start halfway along one side and leave a 20 cm tail. Sew the binding to the front, raw edges together, with a 0.75 cm seam, mitring each corner as shown.
5. Join the two ends with a diagonal seam, finish sewing, turn the binding to the back and hand-stitch its fold over the seam. Hand-stitch the lower edge of the sleeve.
6. Add a label: your name, the year, and “Kogge”.



--- Suggested quilting lines

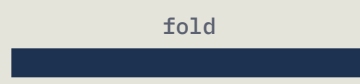


1 Sew across, right sides together



seam pressed open

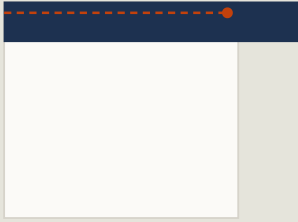
2 Trim, press the seam open



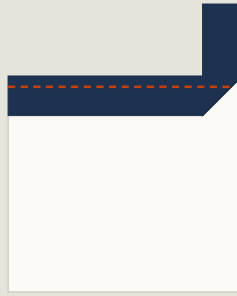
fold
raw edges

3 Press in half lengthwise

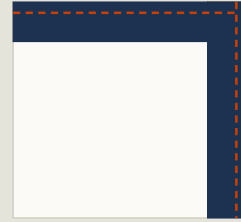
Joining the binding strips. The pale strip is shown wrong side up.



1 Stop one seam allowance short



2 Fold the strip up at 45°



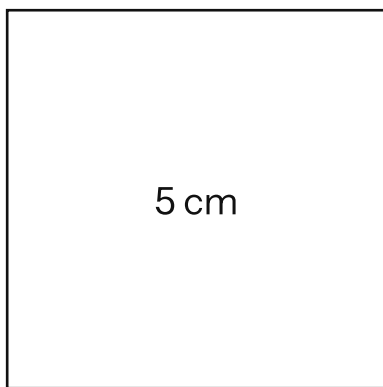
3 Fold it down, sew from the edge

Mitring a corner. Turn the quilt and carry on down the next side.

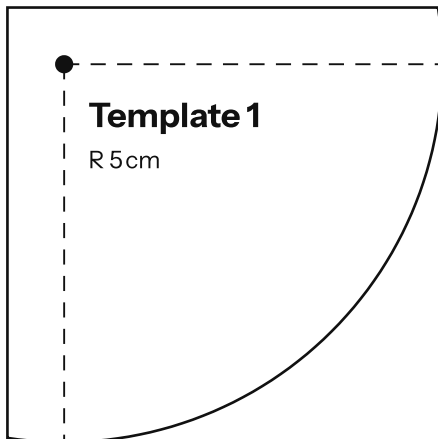
Quarter-circle templates

Print these pages at 100 % (“actual size”, not “fit to page”) and measure the test square before you trace. Each template is a quarter circle around the corner of the finished unit. Its straight edges include the seam allowance and go on the raw edges of the background square; the dashed lines are the seam lines.

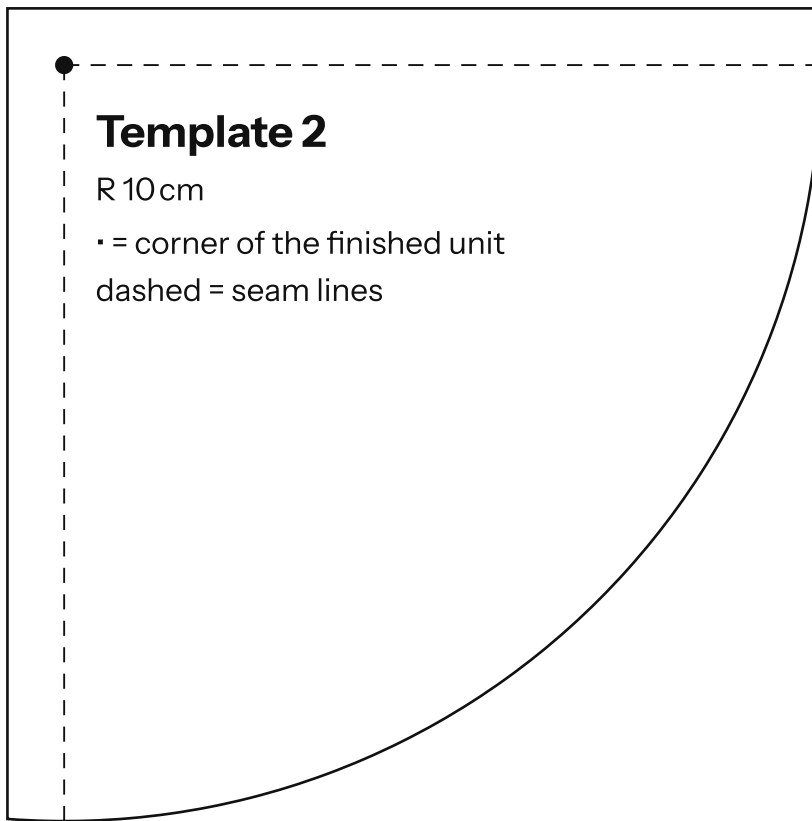
Templates 4 and 5 are too big for one page and come in parts. Cut each part along its edges marked ∞, lay it over the grey strip of the next part so the cut edge sits on the dashed line and the short marks meet, and tape. Then cut the template out along its outline. If you prefer, draw these two arcs with a string compass instead: tie a pencil to a strip of card, pin the card at the corner dot and swing the pencil.



Test square: must measure 5 × 5 cm



Template 1 · R 5 cm · trace 28: 8 sailcloth (Q1), 4 Baltic navy (Q2), 2 Hanse red (Q3), 12 aqua (Q4), 2 oak brown (Q5)



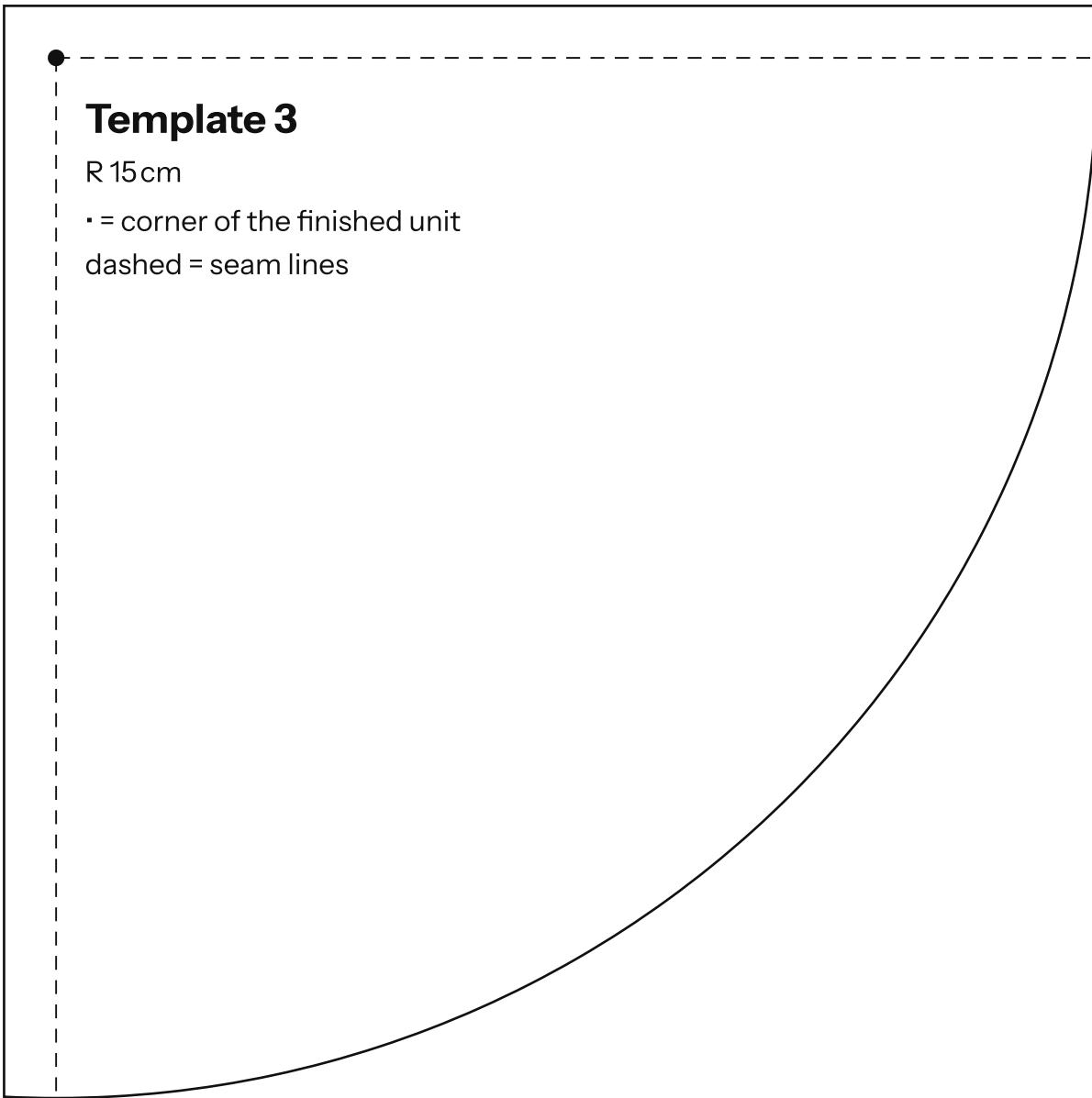
Template 2 · R 10 cm · trace 15: 12 teal (Q4), 2 copper (Q5), 1 Hanse red (Q6)

Template 3

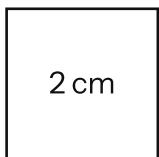
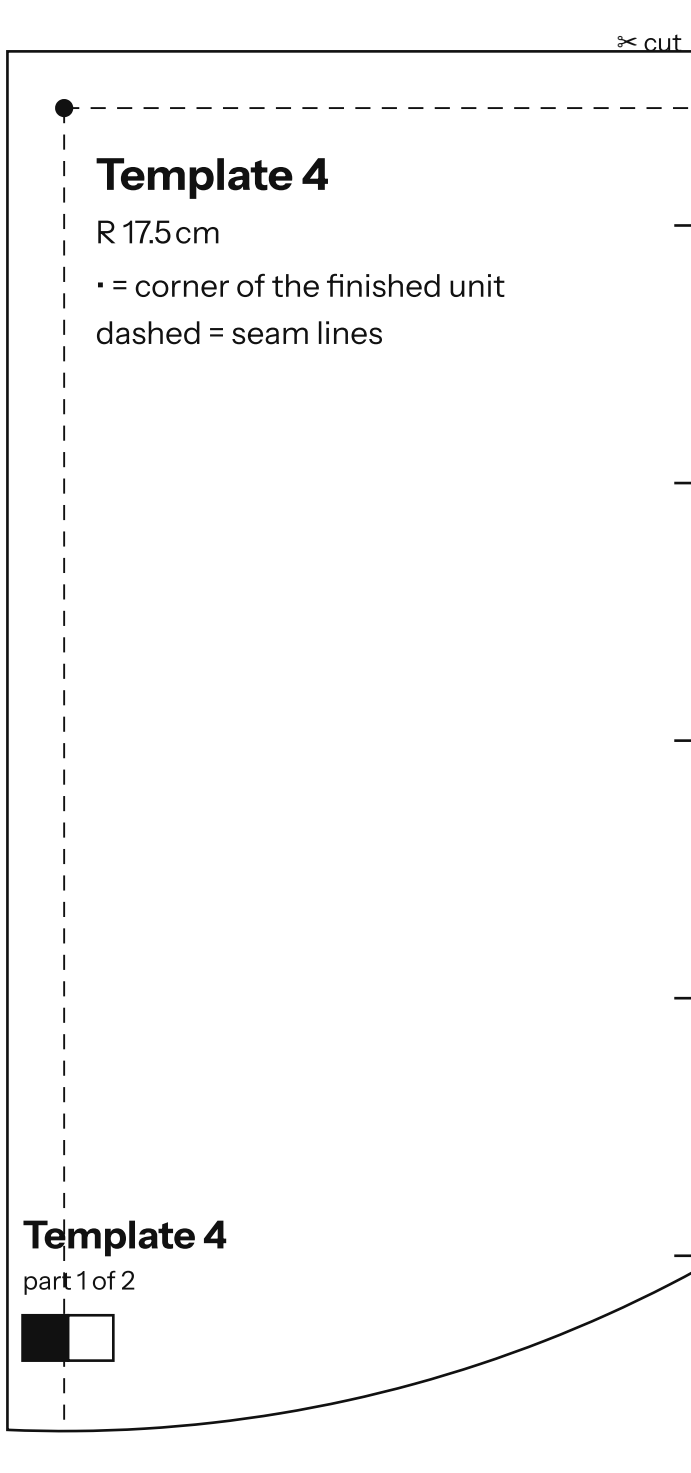
R 15cm

• = corner of the finished unit

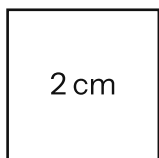
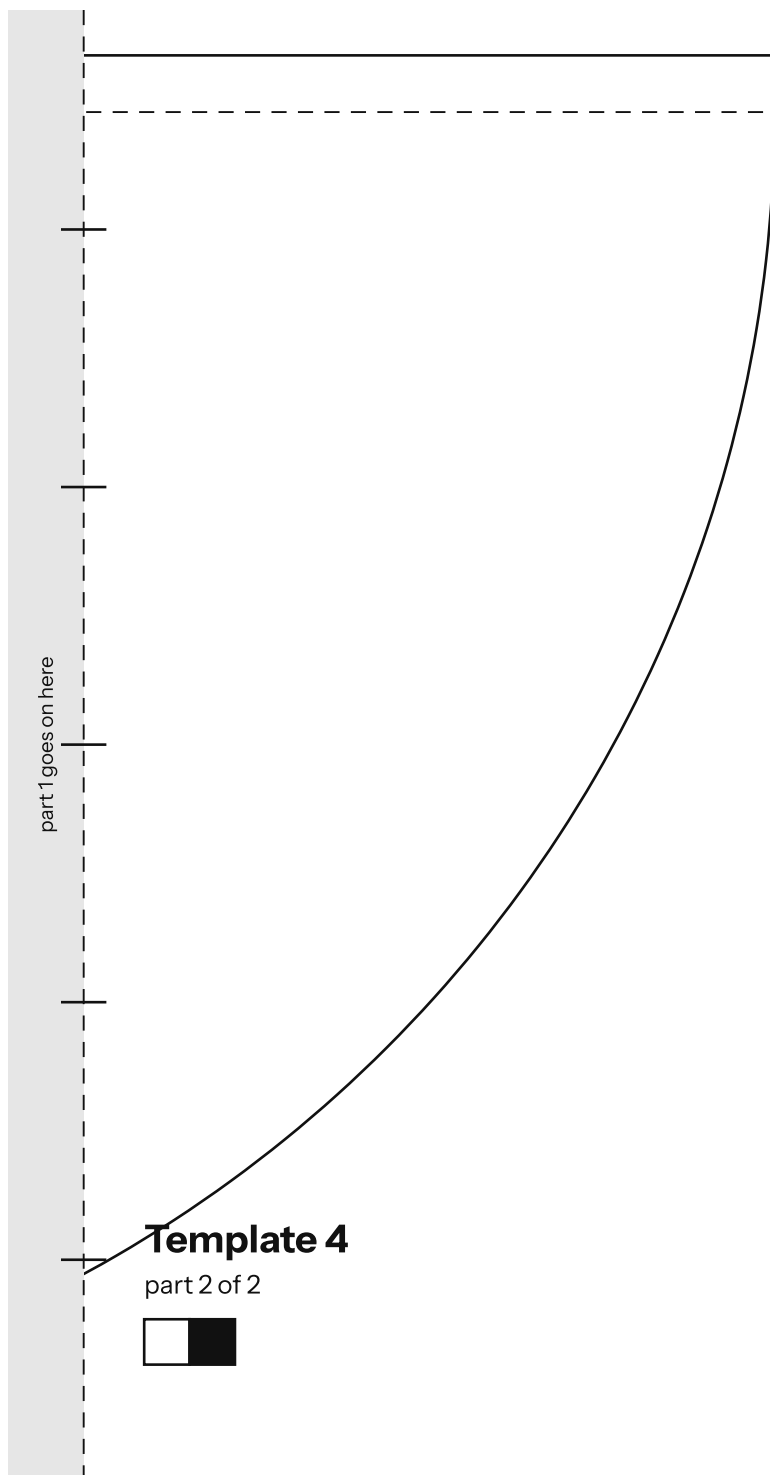
dashed = seam lines



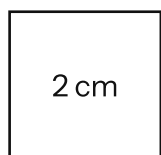
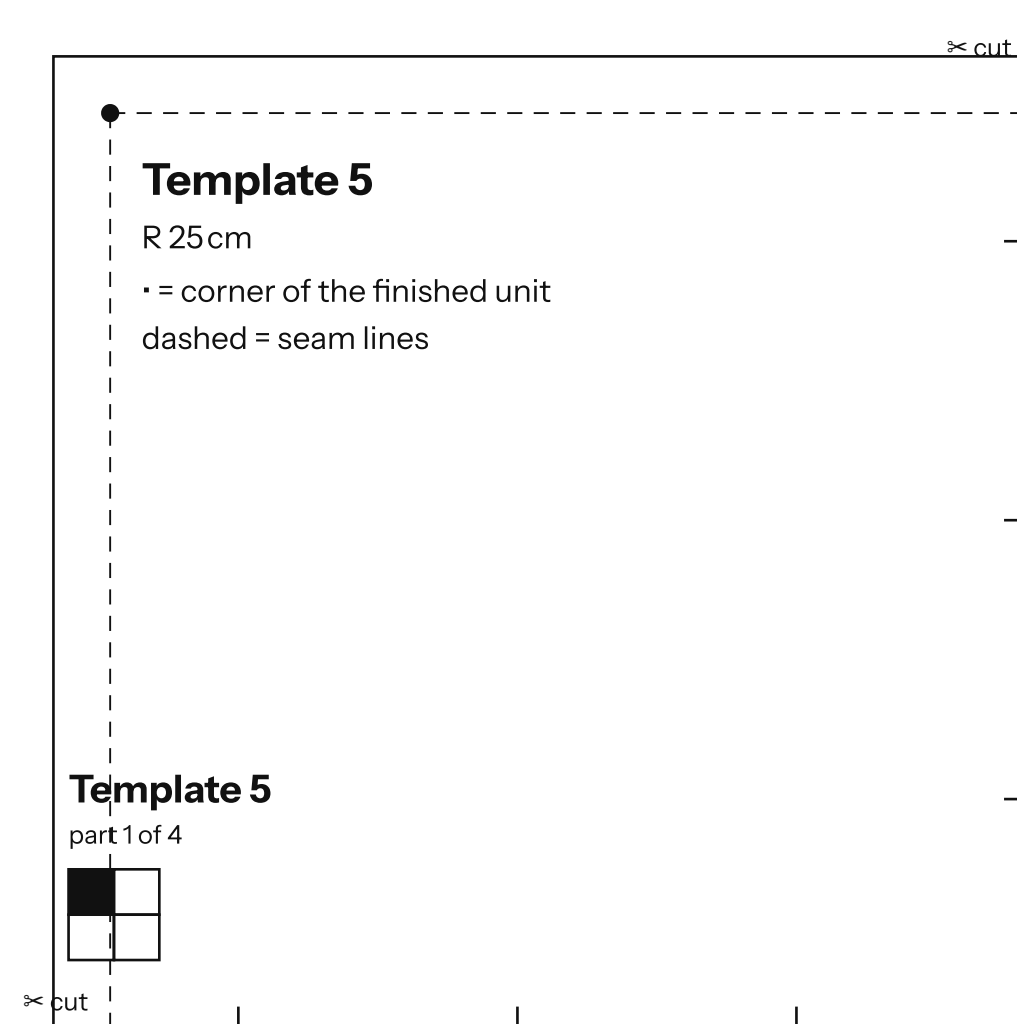
Template 3 · R 15cm · trace 2: 2 oak brown (Q5)



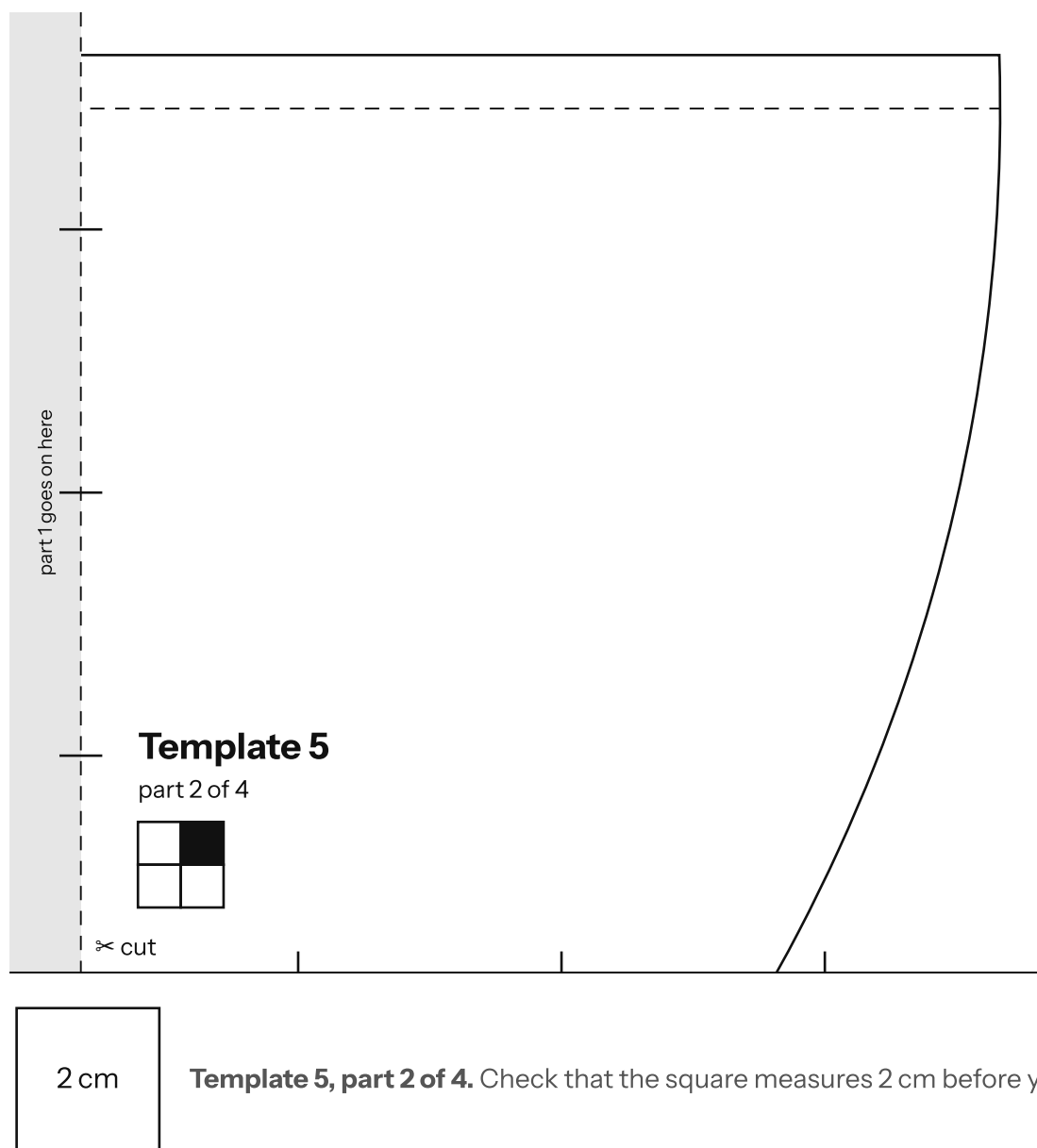
Template 4, part 1 of 2. Check that the square measures 2 cm before you cut. Template 4 · R 17.5 cm · trace 1: 1 copper (Q6).

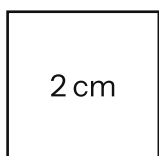
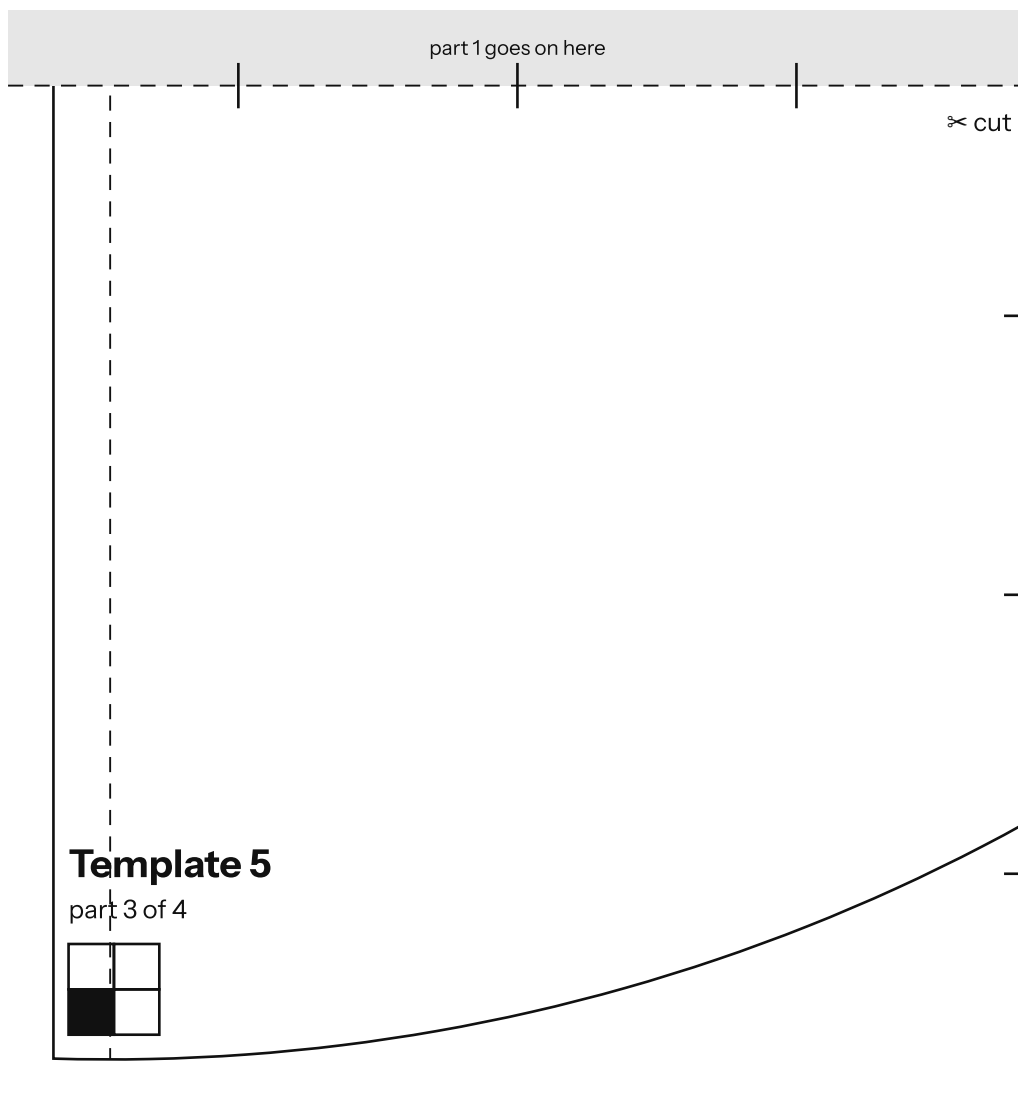


Template 4, part 2 of 2. Check that the square measures 2 cm before you cut.

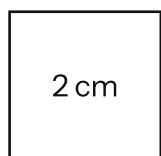
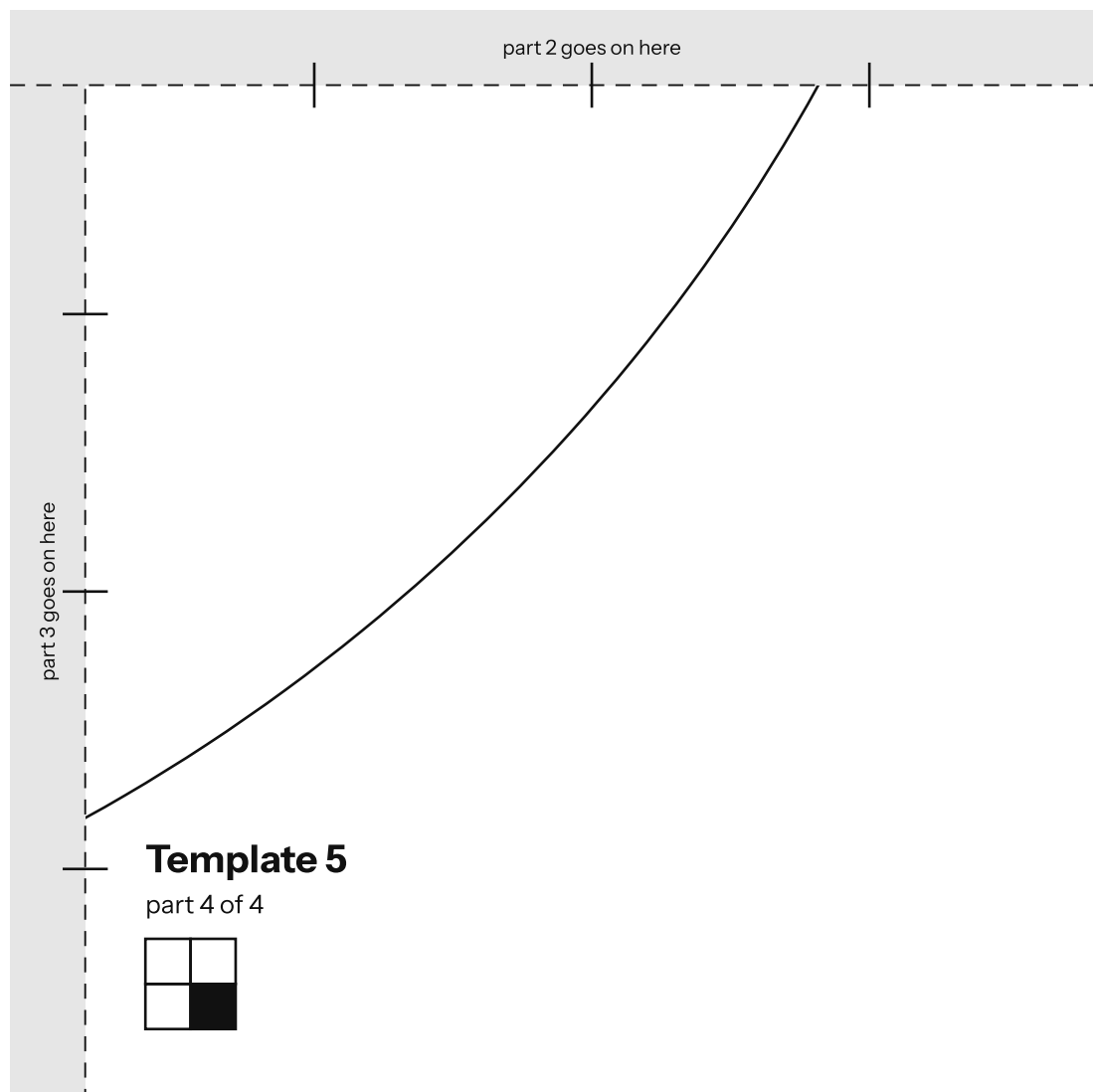


Template 5, part 1 of 4. Check that the square measures 2 cm before you cut. Template 5 · R 25cm · trace 1: 1 sun gold (Q6).





Template 5, part 3 of 4. Check that the square measures 2 cm before you cut.



Template 5, part 4 of 4. Check that the square measures 2 cm before you cut.

Layout chart

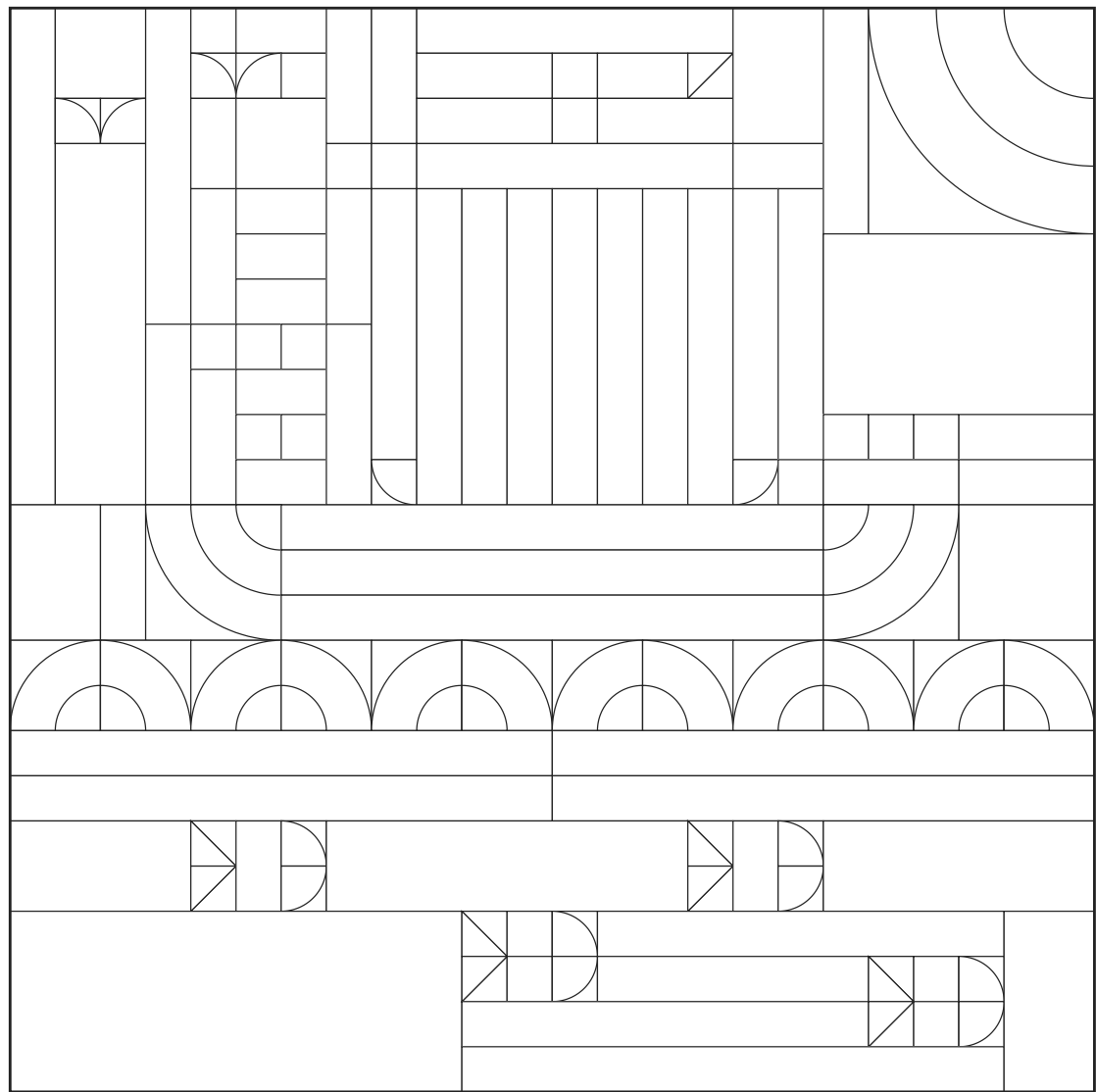
The whole quilt with every piece code. Brackets mark the sections. Triangle and quarter-circle units carry their codes in the section steps.



REFERENCE

Colour your own

Print this page and try your own colours before you buy fabric. Every line is a seam or the edge of a quarter circle.



Kogge is an original quilt design, inspired by the modular geometric illustrations of Siggi Eggertsson and by the Bremen cog of about 1380. Every measurement, cutting plan and diagram on this page is generated from one design grid and checked against it, and the top was also sewn in software with real seam allowances.

Pattern version 1.1, October 2026. Please read all instructions before you start.